

Sinocera Functional Material (300285.SZ): NDR takeaways: Solid core business; pace of new product commercialization varies

We hosted Sinocera's management for an NDR call on Aug 6, post its 2Q26 results (see our first take [here](#)). Management highlighted continued strength across its core businesses, supported by robust MLCC powder shipment growth, strong market share gains in new energy materials, and re-acceleration in biomedical materials. Looking ahead, pricing trends are becoming more supportive in MLCC powder and biomedical materials, driven by industry-wide price recovery and recent product price hikes.

For new product, management expects auto-grade/AI-server MLCC powders and spherical silicon to ramp shipments in 2H26, while emphasizing their significantly higher ASP and margins relative to traditional products. In contrast, commercialization timelines for sulfide solid-state electrolytes and AI data center ceramic substrates remain less certain due to customer validation progress and downstream adoption pace. Management also noted that rare earth export controls could create incremental share gain opportunities in both dental zirconia and MLCC materials as overseas competitors face supply disruptions.

Below we summarize our key takeaways from the NDR call.

Nick Zheng, CFA
+852-2978-1405 | nick.zheng@gs.com
Goldman Sachs (Asia) L.L.C.

Selina Yan
+852-2978-0178 | shuling.yan@gs.com
Goldman Sachs (Asia) L.L.C.

Traditional businesses

Electronic Materials

■ MLCC Powder:

- **Shipment:** 1H26 shipments reached 3.6k tons (+21% yoy) with **capacity near full utilization. The full-year target remains unchanged at 8,500–9,000 tons.**
- **Pricing:** ASP in 1H26 saw **10%+ yoy/hoh decline** due to price discounts on legacy products. Looking ahead, management noted that major players have begun raising prices and **Sinocera will adjust the price based on market conditions.**

- **Electronic Pastes:** 1H26 revenue exceeded Rmb100 million for the first time (+20% yoy), driven by accelerating domestic substitution.

New Energy Materials

- Segment **revenue saw strong growth of +50% yoy in 1H26, driven by market**

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share gains in high-purity alumina and boehmite. GPM expanded notably due to improved capacity utilization.

Bio-medical Materials

- Segment sales grew +25% yoy in 1H26. By product, dental zirconia powders saw solid sales volume growth of +10% yoy and management mentioned a price hike of 10%–40% has been implemented in late July 2026 to offset rising raw material costs. Upcera sales were up +15% yoy and company has launched its high-end zirconia blocks in the overseas market.
- Although GPM continued to trend down in 1H26, the recent price hikes and ongoing product upgrades are expected to drive segment margin recovery.
- **M&A:** The privatization of Australian ASX-listed dental materials company SDI Limited was completed in July. This acquisition is expected to expand Sinocera's clinical product pipelines, enhance its international sales channel capabilities, and elevate its premium global branding.

Other Segments

- **Catalyst Materials:** Sales growth was relatively mild (+SD% yoy) in 1H26, primarily dragged by sluggish demand in the domestic automotive market.
- **Precision Ceramics:** This was the only segment that saw sales decline in 1H26, pressured by intensifying industry competition in ceramic balls and slower-than-expected demand ramp-up for satellite-use ceramic packages.
- **Construction Ceramics:** 1H26 sales were up +17% yoy. GPM was pressured the most among all segments due to rising raw material costs. Management emphasized that overseas market expansion remains the key priority for the segment.

New businesses

AI & Automotive-Grade MLCC Powder

- **Capacity & Shipments:** Out of 5,000-ton planned capacity, Phase I capacity of 2,000+ tons has been completed. Management shared validation is complete with key domestic and overseas clients and expects **shipments to ramp up in 2H26, with full-year targets at several hundred tons** (capped at 1,000 tons due to capacity).
- **Pricing & Margins:** Management shared ceramic powder is priced at Rmb60k+/ton for traditional products (consumer electronics), while for new products – **automotive-grade is priced at ~Rmb100k/ton, and AI server-grade at Rmb100k–200k+/ton**. Automotive and AI powders command ~45% GPM, vs. 35%+ for traditional products.

Spherical Silicon

- **Validation & Capacity:** Management expects several clients to grant product validation in 4Q26, with **initial sales expected within the year**. A **2,000-ton capacity expansion is scheduled to launch by early 2027**, with next year's capacity utilization expected to exceed 50%.

- **Pricing & Margins:** Management shared M8–M9 grades are priced at **Rmb200k–300k/ton with ~45% GPM**. Management highlighted the addressable market is meaningful at c.Rmb10bn annually.

Other products

- **Sulfide Solid-State Electrolytes: Small-volume shipments are expected this year**, with sales volumes rising further next year. However, due to high production costs, **mass production will take time**.
- **Semiconductor Thermoelectric Ceramic Substrates: Small-batch deliveries will commence in 4Q26**, with revenue potential reaching **tens of millions of RMB next year**.
- **Zirconia & Titania Dispersion Liquids (for Smartphone Screens & AR Glasses):** Revenue is expected to reach **tens of millions of RMB this year**. If AR penetration accelerates, revenue could scale to high tens of millions of RMB next year.
- **AI Data Center Ceramic Substrates:** Management mentioned validation is unlikely to conclude this year, with **visibility shifting to next year**. While the addressable market is substantial, **validation timelines remain highly uncertain**.

Impact of rare earth exports control

Dental Zirconia Powder

- Management mentioned due to rare earth export controls, supply from Japan peers faces uncertainty, and some listco peers within the dental material space have already experienced supply disruptions.
- Sinocera is actively capitalizing this window to accelerate the premium client onboarding.

MLCC

- Regarding the industry supply disruption, management mentioned Japanese peers maintain strategic inventories, and overseas clients are proactively stockpiling.
- In terms of the share gain opportunities, management mentioned Sinocera now has minimal Japanese client exposure but is well-positioned to capture market share as competitor supply tightens. Management highlighted rare earth additives account for only SD% in Sinocera's MLCC formulation powder and cannot be extracted after sintering. Therefore, exports of the formulation power are unaffected by the current control.

Investment Thesis – Sinocera Functional Material

Sinocera is China's leading supplier of fine ceramic materials, with unique exposure to end-markets and products (e.g., electronic, catalytic, new energy and bio-medical materials) where we see structural growth opportunities with import substitution potential – offering Sinocera a long growth runway for the next decade. With a proven track record of expanding TAM through organic R&D development and M&A, we expect Sinocera to revert to its fast earnings growth trajectory in the medium-to-long-term,

especially on the back of Sinocera's encouraging developments in new products that could allow the company to capitalize the emerging technology megatrends (e.g. AI, solid-state batteries, AR/VR, etc.). We are Neutral rated on the stock as we believe current valuation seems to have largely reflected the long-term growth potential. **Key risks:** 1) Slower/faster-than-expected ceramic powder market share expansion by Sinocera; 2) Slower/faster-than-expected expansion of its new businesses; 3) Slower/faster-than-expected end-market growth.

Price Target Risks and Methodology – Sinocera Functional Material

Valuation: We base our 12-month target price of Rmb33.0 on a 25x 2030E P/E discounted back to mid-2027E using a 10.0% COE. Our exit multiple of 25x is derived based on the weighted average 10-year mid-cycle P/E of the key global players for Sinocera's end-markets.

Key risks: 1) Slower/faster-than-expected ceramic powder market share expansion by Sinocera; 2) Slower/faster-than-expected expansion of its new businesses; 3) Slower/faster-than-expected end-market growth.

300285.SZ	12m Price Target: Rmb33.00	Price: Rmb70.88	Downside: 53.4%
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Neutral		GS Forecast			
		12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Market cap: Rmb71.2bn / \$10.5bn	Revenue (Rmb mn)	4,582.6	5,413.2	6,491.9	7,632.3
Enterprise value: Rmb71.5bn / \$10.6bn	EBITDA (Rmb mn)	1,001.8	1,271.4	1,628.0	1,978.8
3m ADTV: Rmb7.9bn / \$1.2bn	EPS (Rmb)	0.61	0.77	1.02	1.26
China	P/E (X)	32.4	91.7	69.7	56.3
China Battery, Machinery & Advanced Materials	P/B (X)	2.8	9.1	8.3	7.5
M&A Rank: 3	Dividend yield (%)	0.7	0.3	0.4	0.4
Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: No	N debt/EBITDA (ex lease,X)	(0.3)	(0.3)	(0.3)	(0.4)
	CROCI (%)	13.0	12.3	14.1	15.4
	FCF yield (%)	2.0	0.4	0.5	0.9
		3/26	6/26E	9/26E	12/26E
	EPS (Rmb)	0.14	0.22	0.19	0.22

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 7 Aug 2026 close.

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Contributing Authors: Nick Zheng, CFA Goldman Sachs (Asia) L.L.C., Selina Yan Goldman Sachs (Asia) L.L.C..

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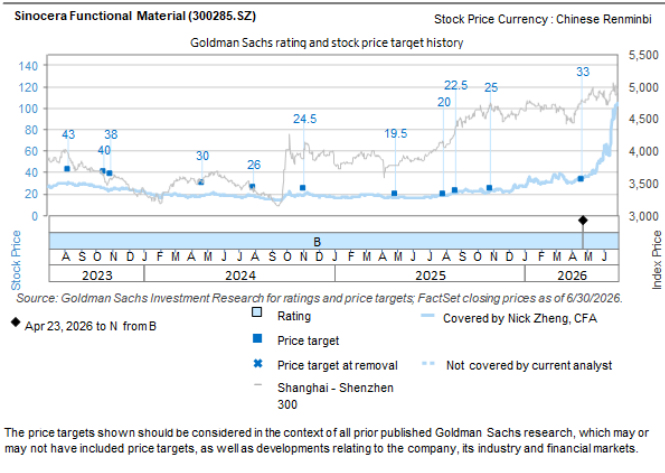
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Price target and rating history chart(s)



Target price history table(s)
Sinocera Functional Material (300285.SZ)

Date of report	Target price (Rmb)	Closing price (Rmb)
24-Apr-26	33.00	35.51
29-Oct-25	25.00	23.21
23-Aug-25	22.50	20.57
31-Jul-25	20.00	18.40
28-Apr-25	19.50	16.60
05-Nov-24	24.50	19.75
31-Jul-24	26.00	18.92
22-Apr-24	30.00	18.47
29-Oct-23	38.00	23.73
17-Oct-23	40.00	25.86

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